

help turn providence in our favor. Their reach goes far beyond how we earn our living, for never forget that none of us lives by bread alone.

Commitment to Family and Community

The well-rounded life requires other commitments, too. These commitments begin with our families. Until we are committed, there is the chance to draw back, but once we commit ourselves to family, all sorts of things occur that might never have otherwise occurred. For me, commitment to family has brought the blessings of marriage (Eve and I have now enjoyed nearly 52 magical years together), the blessings of children, the blessings of grandchildren, and perhaps one day even the blessings of great-grandchildren.

Commitment to our neighbors and our community is also vital. In this increasingly individualistic age, community spirit—once exemplified by the barn raising, the quilting bee, the fence-mending—seems almost a quaint anachronism. But a spirit of cooperation and togetherness is today more important than ever, especially in our urban areas where enormous wealth and grinding poverty exist side by side, and where, paradoxically, both extremes seem to lead away from the kind of community spirit that is at the core of the civility that has made living in American communities so worthwhile.

I am not at all embarrassed to mention the constructive role of religion in fostering these higher values. While I won't dwell now on the Judeo-Christian values that I deeply cherish, I would note that virtually all religions preach the existence of a supreme being, the virtues of a Golden Rule, and standards of conduct that parallel the Ten Commandments. We thrive as human beings and as families not by *what faith* we happen to hold, but by *having faith*, faith in something far greater than ourselves.

The Commitment to Citizenship